ORB External API v1.0.7 — Mini Release Note

This release updates the ORB External API documentation and OpenAPI specification previously shared as v1.0.6.

- **Compatibility.**
  - All changes are backwards compatible with existing EHR integrations.
  - The Governing Body / External Client API key (X-API-KEY) still works on all endpoints, including organisation-scoped requests.
  - Organisation API keys (X-ORG-API-KEY) are optional. Existing integrations can continue using X-API-KEY without any changes.
  - Existing Create and Connect requests remain valid, including those that provide organisation addresses or patient postcodes.
  - Endpoint paths, required identifiers (extOrganisationId, extUserId, extPatientId), Connect matching, rate limits, contract signing and widget/access-token flows remain unchanged, except where noted below.
- **Organisation-level API keys (X-ORG-API-KEY)**
  - The API now supports organisation-specific keys alongside the existing Governing Body key.
  - An organisation key can only be used for its own organisation. If both keys are provided, ORB uses X-ORG-API-KEY and ignores X-API-KEY.
  - Organisation keys are accepted on organisation-scoped endpoints under /organisations/{extOrganisationId} and on Stats requests that include extOrganizationKey.
  - The Governing Body key is still required for Create, Delete and List Organisations, Generate Organisation API Key, and Stats requests without extOrganizationKey.
  - The Governing Body can generate an organisation's first key using POST /organisations/{extOrganisationId}/api-key. The full key is returned once and cannot be retrieved again.
  - If a key already exists, the API returns 409 OrgApiKeyAlreadyExists. Key regeneration, disabling and re-enabling are managed by ORB.
  - New error codes: OrgApiKeyInvalid, OrgApiDisabled, OrgApiKeyExpired (403) and OrgApiKeyAlreadyExists (409).
  - Widget and contract access tokens are linked to the key used to request them. A new token is needed if that key is regenerated, disabled or expires.
- **Create Organisation — address optional**
  - address1, address2, address3, address4 and postcode are now optional.
  - An organisation can be created with organisationName and extOrganisationId in the endpoint path. Address fields can be omitted, set to null or left empty.
  - Existing requests that include an address still work.
  - phoneNumber, cqcRegistrationNumber and researchOptOut are unchanged.

- **Update Organisation — address clearing**
  - Address fields now follow the same PATCH rules as phoneNumber: omit to keep the existing value, send null to clear it, or provide a new value.
  - Empty strings and whitespace are stored as provided.
  - Existing PATCH requests remain valid.
  - cqcRegistrationNumber still trims values and clears the field when empty or whitespace-only.
- **Connect Patient — postcode optional**
  - Postcode is no longer required for Connect Patient by Email or Connect Patient by Link.
  - Omitted, null, empty and whitespace-only values are accepted. Non-empty postcodes are still limited to 15 characters.
  - Existing requests that include a postcode continue to work. Other required fields are unchanged.
- **Update Patient — postcode clearing**
  - Postcode now follows the same PATCH rules: omit to keep the existing value, send null to clear it, or provide a new value.
  - Empty strings and whitespace are stored as provided. The 15-character limit still applies to non-empty values.
  - A postcode can be added later using Update Patient if the patient was originally connected without one.
  - Existing PATCH requests remain valid.
- **DataMismatch — invitation resend**
  - Connect requests for patients in DataMismatch can now use resend: true to send another NHS registration invitation, subject to the existing invitation rate limit.
  - Without resend: true, Connect continues to return HTTP 422 with the current status.
  - The connection remains in DataMismatch until NHS Login succeeds. Resending an invitation does not change the status to InviteSent.
  - After correcting the patient's details using Update Patient, Connect with resend: true can be used to send a new invitation.
  - This only applies to NHS registration invitations. Data-access request emails and links are unchanged.
- **Delete Organisation — reuse of extOrganisationId**
  - Delete Organisation still archives the organisation and keeps its data.
  - Once archived, the same extOrganisationId can be used to create a new organisation. The archived organisation is not restored, and its patients, users and NHS/clinical data remain associated with it.
  - Subsequent API requests using that ID apply to the new organisation.
  - Active and suspended organisations still reserve their IDs. Attempting to reuse one returns 409 IdNotAvailable.
  - Suspended organisations should be reactivated using Update Organisation with suspended: false.
  - Deleting an already-deleted organisation returns 404 OrgNotFound.

- **NHS Login — NHS number already linked**
    - Connect still matches existing ORB patients by email. Using a different email creates a second patient record.
    - If the patient completes NHS Login with an NHS number already linked to another ORB patient, ORB compares their surname and date of birth with the existing NHS-linked record.
    - If both match, the organisation's connection is linked to the existing patient, extPatientId stays the same, the status becomes Connected and the duplicate record is removed.
    - If either does not match, the connection is set to DataMismatch and the patient sees the mismatch dialog.
    - No second NHS Login is created in either case.
    - EHR identifiers and status endpoints are unchanged. Connection status is still available through Get Patient Connection Status and List Patients, and Connect does not return a new errorCode for this scenario.